

Autonomous line-following Material Transport Robot

A PROJECT REPORT

Submitted by

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*in partial fulfillment for the award of the
degree of*

BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING

IN

MECHANICAL ENGINEERING

KNOWLEDGE INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, SALEM

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JAN 2026

BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

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ABSTRACT

This project presents an Autonomous Line-Following Material Transport Robot designed to automate material handling tasks in industrial and commercial environments. The system utilizes infrared (IR) sensors to detect and follow a predefined path, enabling accurate and continuous navigation without human intervention. A microcontroller processes sensor inputs and controls DC motors through a motor driver to maintain stable movement and direction.

To enhance safety, an ultrasonic sensor is integrated for real-time obstacle detection. The robot continuously monitors the distance to objects ahead and stops or adjusts its motion when obstacles are detected, preventing collisions. This dual functionality of line tracking and obstacle avoidance ensures reliable operation even in dynamic environments.

The proposed system offers a cost-effective and efficient alternative to manual transport, reducing human effort and improving consistency. Its modular design allows future upgrades such as wireless control and vision-based navigation. Overall, the robot demonstrates effective path tracking, safe operation, and suitability for applications in industries, warehouses, and automation systems.

Keywords: Autonomous Robot, Line Following, Obstacle Detection, Ultrasonic Sensor, Material Transport, Embedded Systems

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LIST OF SYMBOLS, ABBREVIATIONS AND NOMENCLATURE

1. SYMBOLS:

Symbol	Meaning
V	Voltage (Volts)
I	Current (Amperes)
mA	Milliamperes
mm	Millimeters
KB	kilobytes
MHz	million cycles per second.
RPM	Revolutions Per Minute
cm	CentiMeter

2. ABBREVIATIONS:

Abbreviation	Full Form
IR	Infrared
DC	Direct Current
PWM	Pulse Width Modulation

3. NOMENCLATURE:

Term	Definition / Description
Autonomous Robot	A robot capable of performing tasks independently without human intervention.
Line Following	A navigation method in which the robot follows a predefined path using sensors.
Arduino UNO	ATmega328P-based microcontroller board used as the main control unit of the robot.
IR Sensor	Infrared sensor used to detect the path by sensing differences in surface reflectivity.
Ultrasonic Sensor	Sensor that measures distance using ultrasonic waves for obstacle detection.
Obstacle Detection	Process of identifying objects in the robot's path to prevent collisions.
L298N Motor Driver	Dual H-Bridge motor driver module used to control the speed and direction of DC motors.
DC Gear Motor	Electric motor with a gearbox that provides controlled speed and higher torque for robot movement.
Closed-Loop Control	Control system that continuously adjusts operation based on sensor feedback.
Material Transport System	Automated mechanism used to carry materials from one location to another efficiently.

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

Automation has become a fundamental component in modern industries, aiming to improve productivity, reduce human effort, and ensure consistent performance. With the advancement of embedded systems and robotics, autonomous machines are increasingly being used for tasks such as material handling, transportation, and inspection. Among these, line-following robots provide a simple yet effective solution for guided navigation in structured environments.

The **Autonomous Line-Following Material Transport Robot** is designed to automate the process of transporting materials along a predefined path. The system uses infrared (IR) sensors to detect a line marked on the ground and follows it accurately by continuously adjusting its movement. A microcontroller processes the sensor inputs and controls the motors through a motor driver, ensuring smooth and stable navigation.

In addition to path tracking, safety is a critical aspect in real-world applications. To address this, the system is integrated with an ultrasonic sensor for obstacle detection. This sensor enables the robot to identify objects in its path and respond appropriately by stopping or modifying its movement, thereby preventing collisions and ensuring safe operation.

The proposed system is cost-effective, easy to implement, and suitable for small- and medium-scale industrial applications such as warehouses, manufacturing units, and hospitals. By replacing manual material transport with an autonomous solution, the system reduces labor dependency, minimizes human errors, and improves overall efficiency.

Furthermore, the design is modular, allowing future enhancements such as wireless communication, obstacle avoidance algorithms, and vision-based navigation.

This makes the project a strong foundation for developing advanced autonomous robotic systems aligned with modern automation trends.

In conclusion, this project demonstrates the practical implementation of an autonomous robot capable of efficient material transport with integrated safety features, contributing to the growing field of industrial automation and smart systems.

1.1 METHODOLOGY

The methodology adopted for the development of the **Autonomous Line-Following Material Transport Robot with Obstacle Detection** follows a systematic approach that integrates sensing, control, and actuation to achieve reliable navigation and safe operation.

Initially, the robot detects the predefined path using infrared (IR) sensors. These sensors differentiate between the line and the surrounding surface based on reflectivity, providing continuous input signals to the microcontroller. The sensed data is then processed to determine the position of the robot relative to the path. Based on this information, a control algorithm is implemented to adjust the speed and direction of the motors, ensuring accurate line tracking.

Simultaneously, an ultrasonic sensor is used for real-time obstacle detection. The sensor continuously measures the distance between the robot and any object in front of it. If an obstacle is detected within a predefined threshold distance, the system overrides the line-following operation and temporarily stops or alters the movement of the robot to prevent collisions.

The microcontroller acts as the central processing unit, integrating both line-following and obstacle detection functionalities. It generates control signals for the motor driver, which regulates the operation of DC gear motors. These motors drive the wheels of the robot, enabling forward, left, and right movements based on the control logic.

The overall system operates in a closed-loop manner, where sensor feedback is continuously monitored and used to update the robot's movement in real time. This ensures stability, accuracy, and adaptability under varying environmental conditions. The methodology emphasizes simplicity, efficiency, and reliability, making the system suitable for practical implementation in industrial material transport applications.

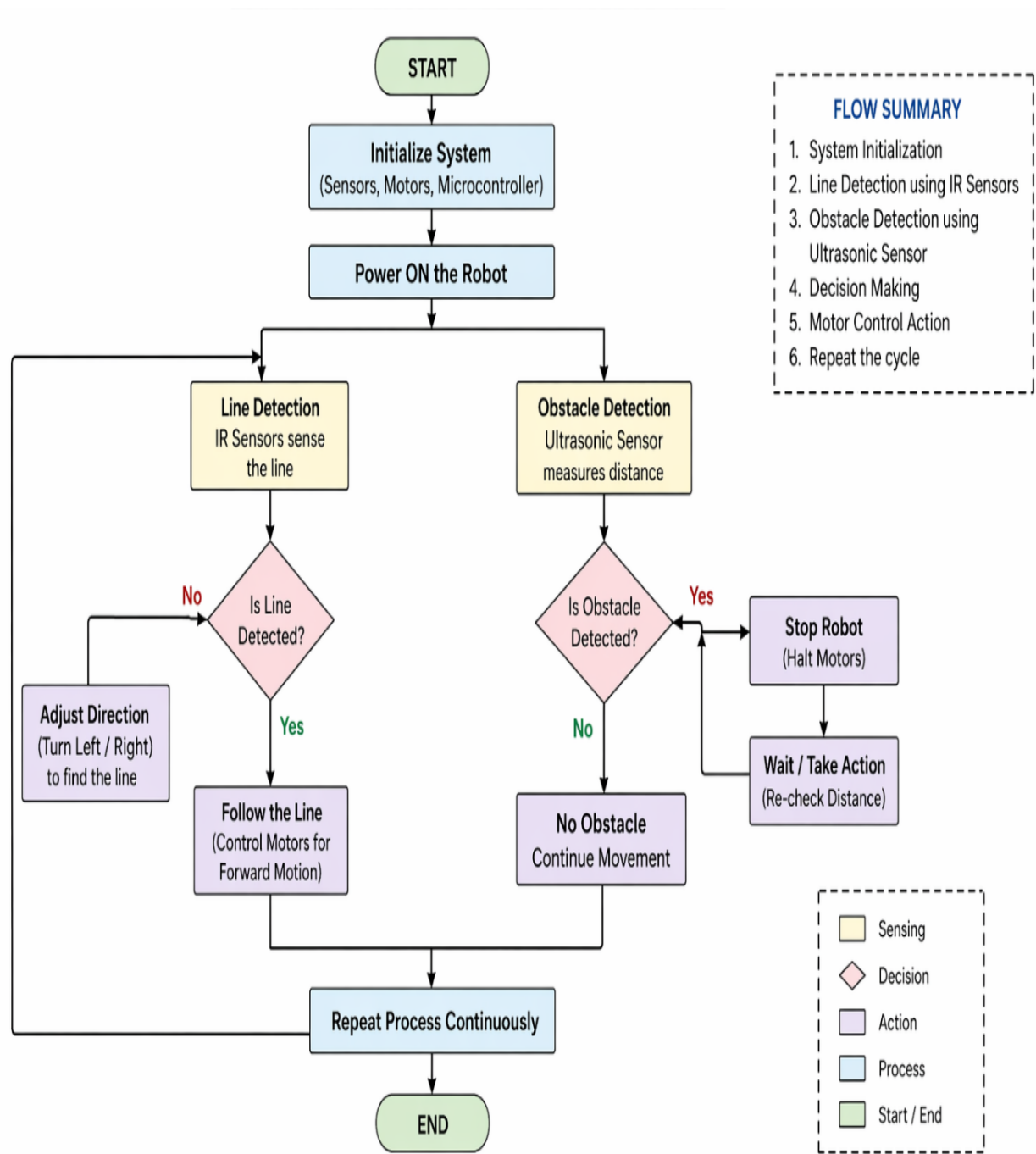


Fig 1.1 Working Methodology

CHAPTER 2

LITERATURE REVIEW

1. Line Follower Robot: A Meta-Analytic Approach

The authors presented a comprehensive study on line-following robots by analyzing various sensing techniques, control algorithms, and system designs. The paper highlights the use of infrared sensors and basic control logic for accurate path tracking. The study concludes that sensor-based approaches are reliable, cost-effective, and suitable for structured environments such as industries and warehouses.

2. Drivable Path Detection for Mobile Robot Using Deep Learning [2]

The authors developed a deep learning-based approach for detecting drivable paths using vision systems. The system uses neural networks to identify paths in complex environments, improving navigation flexibility. The results showed higher accuracy compared to traditional methods, but the system requires significant computational power, making it less suitable for low-cost embedded applications.

3. Bio-Inspired Autonomous Learning Algorithm for Robot Navigation [3]

The authors proposed a bio-inspired learning algorithm for robot navigation combined with obstacle avoidance. The system adapts to environmental changes and improves navigation efficiency through learning mechanisms. The study demonstrated enhanced performance in dynamic environments, though it increases system complexity.

4. Autonomous Navigation in Robotics: A Review [4]

The authors provided a detailed review of autonomous navigation techniques including SLAM, path planning, and control systems. The study highlights the importance of integrating sensing and decision-making for efficient navigation. It concludes that autonomous systems require a combination of multiple technologies for optimal performance.

5. Machine Learning Approaches in Robotics [5]

The authors explored various machine learning techniques applied in robotics for intelligent decision-making. The study emphasizes how machine learning improves adaptability and system performance.

6. Deep Reinforcement Learning for Robot Path Planning [6]

The authors developed a reinforcement learning-based system for robot path planning. The robot learns optimal navigation strategies through interaction with the environment. The results showed improved performance in dynamic conditions, but training complexity and time remain major limitations.

7. Control of Line Following Robot Using Neural Networks [7]

The authors proposed a neural network-based control system using CNN and LSTM models for line-following robots. The system improves tracking accuracy and stability compared to traditional methods. The study demonstrates better performance but increases design complexity and computational requirements.

8. Mobile Robot Navigation Using Sensor Fusion Techniques [8]

The authors developed a navigation system that combines multiple sensors to improve accuracy and reliability. The sensor fusion approach enhances performance by reducing errors from individual sensors. However, the system becomes more complex and costly due to multiple sensor integration.

9. Autonomous Mobile Robot Control Systems: A Review [9]

The authors reviewed different control strategies such as PID, adaptive control, and intelligent control methods. The study emphasizes the importance of control systems in maintaining stability and accuracy in robot movement. It concludes that proper control design is essential for efficient robot operation.

10. Vision-Based Autonomous Navigation for Mobile Robots [10]

The authors presented a vision-based navigation system using cameras for path detection. The system offers flexibility and adaptability in various environments. However, it is sensitive to lighting conditions and requires high processing power, limiting its use in low-cost systems.

CHAPTER 3

COMPONENTS SPECIFICATION AND DESCRIPTION

3.1 Components

The list of components used are,

S.NO.	COMPONENTS	QUANTITY
1	Arduino UNO	1
2	L298N (Motor Driver)	1
3	IR Sensor Module	2
4	Ultrasonic Sensor (HC-SR04)	1
5	Robot Kit	1
6	18650 battery holder -3 cell	1
7	18650 battery cell 3.7V	3
8	Switch	1

Table 3.1 List of Components

3.2 Components description

3.2.1 Arduino UNO

The Arduino UNO is an open-source micro controller board based on the ATmega328P micro controller. It serves as the central processing unit for this project, controlling the operation of the conveyor motor, IR sensor, and defect detection logic. The board consists of 14 digital input/output pins (of which 6 can be used as PWM outputs), 6 analog inputs, a 16 MHz quartz crystal, a USB connection, a power jack, and a reset button. In this project, the Arduino UNO receives the signal from the IR sensor to detect the presence of a bottle on the conveyor. Once the signal is received, the micro controller sends commands to the motor driver (L298N) to control the movement of the conveyor belt. It also processes the inspection signals received from the image-processing system to

determine whether to continue or stop the belt for inspection.



Figure 3.1 Arduino UNO Board

3.2.2 L298N Motor Driver

The L298N is a dual H-bridge motor driver module that allows control of the direction and speed of two DC motors simultaneously. It serves as the power interface between the Arduino UNO and the DC gear motors. The L298N works on the principle of H-bridge circuits, which enable voltage to be applied in both directions across a load, allowing forward and reverse rotation of the motors. In this project, the L298N module receives low-voltage control signals from the Arduino UNO and provides the required higher current and voltage to drive the conveyor DC motors efficiently.

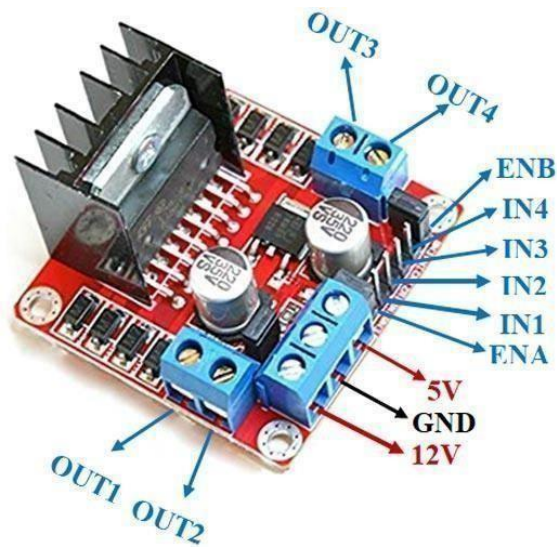


Figure 3.2 L298N Motor Driver Module

3.2.3 IR Sensor

The Infrared (IR) sensor is used to detect the presence or absence of a bottle on the conveyor. It works on the principle of emitting infrared light and measuring the reflection. When a bottle passes in front of the sensor, the reflected IR beam is detected by the receiver, generating a logical signal. In this system, the IR sensor sends a signal to the Arduino UNO whenever a bottle reaches the inspection point, triggering the camera and image-processing sequence.

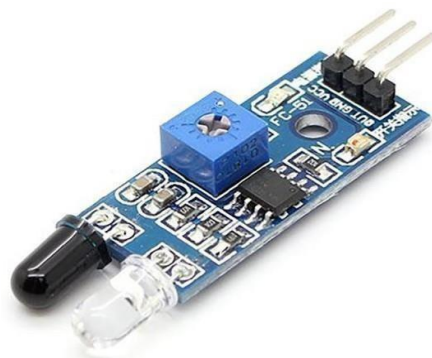


Figure 3.3 IR Sensor Module

3.2.4 Ultrasonic Sensor (HC-SR04)

The HC-SR04 ultrasonic sensor is used in the robot for real-time obstacle detection. It works by emitting ultrasonic sound waves and measuring the time taken for the echo to return after reflecting from an object. Based on this time interval, the distance between the robot and the obstacle is calculated, enabling accurate detection within a range of approximately 2 cm to 400 cm.

In this project, the sensor plays a crucial role in ensuring safe navigation by continuously monitoring the path ahead. When an obstacle is detected within a predefined threshold distance, the sensor sends a signal to the Arduino, which then stops or adjusts the robot's movement to avoid collision. This improves the reliability and safety of the autonomous system, especially in dynamic environments.



Figure 3.4 Ultrasonic Sensor

3.2.5 Robo Car Kit (Chassis, Motors, and Wheels)

The robo car kit forms the mechanical foundation of the autonomous robot, consisting of a chassis, DC gear motors, and wheels. The chassis provides a stable platform for mounting all electronic components such as the Arduino, sensors, motor driver, and battery. It is typically made of lightweight yet durable material, ensuring balance and structural strength during operation.

The DC gear motors attached to the chassis drive the wheels and enable the robot to move in different directions. The wheels are designed to provide proper grip and smooth motion on various surfaces. This combination ensures controlled movement, stability, and efficient performance of the robot during line following and material transport tasks.

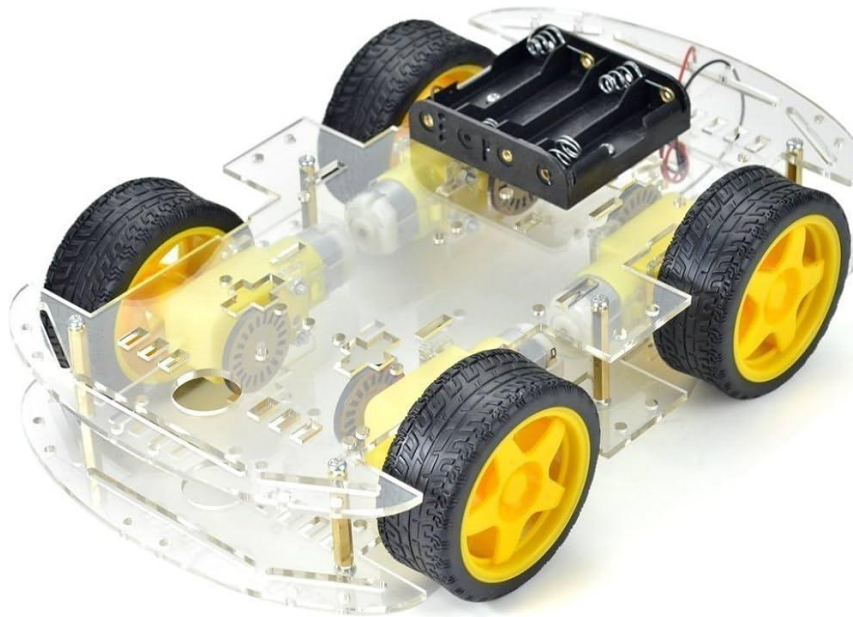


Figure 3.5 Robo Car Kit

3.2.6 Switch

The switch is used to control the power supply of the robot, allowing the system to be turned ON or OFF manually. It is typically connected between the battery and the circuit, acting as a simple control mechanism for starting and stopping the robot. This helps in safe operation and prevents unnecessary power consumption when the system is not in use.

In this project, the switch ensures user convenience and protection of components by avoiding sudden power surges. It also allows quick shutdown of the robot during maintenance or emergency situations, improving overall safety and reliability of the system.



Figure 3.6 Switch

3.2.7 18650 Battery Holder (3-Cell)

The 3-cell 18650 battery holder is used to securely house and connect three lithium-ion battery cells in series. It provides a combined output voltage of approximately 11.1V, which is sufficient to power the motors, controller, and sensors in the robot. The holder ensures proper alignment and electrical connectivity between the cells, maintaining a stable power supply to the system.

In this project, the battery holder plays an important role in organizing the power source and improving safety. It allows easy insertion and removal of batteries, making maintenance convenient. Additionally, it protects the cells from loose connections and ensures reliable operation during continuous robot movement.

3.2.8 18650 Battery Cell (3.7V)

The 18650-battery cell is a rechargeable lithium-ion power source used to supply energy to the robot. Each cell provides a nominal voltage of 3.7V, and when three cells are connected in series, they deliver approximately 11.1V required for the system.

In this project, the 18650 battery cells ensure continuous and reliable operation of the motors, sensors, and controller. They support stable voltage output and efficient performance during movement.



Figure 3.7 18650 Battery Cell

3.2.8 Diode

A diode is an electronic component that allows current to flow in only one direction while blocking it in the opposite direction. It is commonly used for protection purposes in circuits, especially to prevent damage caused by reverse voltage or back current. Diodes are simple yet essential components in electronic systems.

In this project, the diode is used to protect the circuit from voltage spikes and reverse polarity, particularly from the motors. When the motors are switched OFF, they can generate back electromotive force (back EMF), which may damage the Arduino or motor driver. The diode safely diverts this unwanted voltage, ensuring reliable and safe operation of the robot.



Figure 3.8 Diode

CHAPTER 4

WORKING PRINCIPLE

The working principle of the autonomous line-following material transport robot is based on the integration of sensing, control, and actuation systems to achieve precise navigation and safe operation. The robot is designed to move along a predefined path marked on the surface, typically a black line on a white background. This path is detected using infrared (IR) sensors, which operate based on the principle of light reflection. When infrared light is emitted onto the surface, white areas reflect more light while black areas absorb it. This difference in reflectivity allows the sensors to generate distinct signals that indicate the position of the robot relative to the path.

The signals obtained from the IR sensors are continuously fed into the Arduino UNO microcontroller, which acts as the brain of the system. The controller processes these inputs using a predefined algorithm to determine whether the robot is correctly aligned with the path or deviating from it. Based on this analysis, the Arduino sends control signals to adjust the movement of the motors. For example, if the robot deviates to one side, the controller slows down one motor while increasing the speed of the other, enabling the robot to return to the correct path. This real-time adjustment ensures smooth and accurate line-following behavior.

In addition to path tracking, the robot incorporates an ultrasonic sensor (HC-SR04) to enhance safety through obstacle detection. The ultrasonic sensor emits high-frequency sound waves and measures the time taken for the echo to return after hitting an object. Using this time, the distance to the object is calculated. The sensor continuously monitors the area in front of the robot, and when an obstacle is detected within a predefined threshold distance, it sends a signal to the Arduino. The controller then overrides the normal operation and stops the robot or alters its movement to prevent collision.

The motion of the robot is controlled using DC gear motors, which are driven by the L298N motor driver module. Since the Arduino cannot directly provide sufficient current to drive the motors, the motor driver acts as an interface between the controller and the motors. It receives low-power control signals from the Arduino and converts them into higher-power signals required for motor operation. The motor driver also enables directional control, allowing the robot to move forward, backward, or turn as needed. This ensures precise and controlled movement of the robot during operation.

The entire system operates based on a closed-loop control mechanism, where sensor feedback is continuously monitored and used to adjust the robot's movement. This feedback system ensures that the robot responds instantly to changes in path direction or environmental conditions. The continuous interaction between sensors, controller, and actuators improves accuracy, stability, and reliability, making the system suitable for real-time applications.

The robot is powered using three 18650 lithium-ion battery cells connected in series, providing sufficient voltage and current for all components. The battery holder ensures proper connections and stable power supply, while a switch is used to control the power flow for safe operation. Additionally, protective components such as diodes are included to prevent damage from reverse voltage and back electromotive force generated by the motors. Overall, the coordinated functioning of all components enables the robot to perform autonomous line following with efficient material transport and effective obstacle detection, making it suitable for industrial automation and smart system applications.

CHAPTER 5

COST ESTIMATION

S.No	Components	Quantity	Unit Cost (₹)	Total Cost (₹)
1	Arduino UNO	1	500	500
2	L298N Motor Driver	1	150	150
3	IR Sensor Module	2	80	160
4	Ultrasonic Sensor (HC-SR04)	1	120	120
5	Robot Car Kit	1	700	700
6	18650 Battery Holder (3-Cell)	1	100	100
7	18650 Battery Cell (3.7V)	3	120	360
8	Switch	1	30	30
	Total Cost			2120

Table 5.1 Cost Estimation

CHAPTER 6

RESULTS DOCUMENTATION AND SYSTEM OUTPUTS

6.1 Output Observations

In the real-time operation of the autonomous line-following robot, the system continuously tracks the predefined path using IR sensors while simultaneously monitoring obstacles using the ultrasonic sensor. The robot successfully follows the line with smooth directional control and responds instantly when an obstacle is detected. The system output is observed through the robot's movement behavior, such as forward motion, turning actions, and stopping conditions.

The system performance is evaluated based on the following parameters:

- λ Line tracking accuracy
- λ Obstacle detection distance
- λ Response time
- λ Motor control stability
- λ Overall navigation efficiency

These outputs confirm that the robot operates effectively under different conditions and maintains consistent performance.

6.2 Experimental Setup Images

During testing, the robot was placed on different track patterns to analyze its performance. The setup included a black line path on a white surface and obstacles placed at varying distances to test the ultrasonic sensor response.

Figure 6.1 – Robot Setup with Line Path

This figure shows:

- λ The robot placed on a predefined track
- λ IR sensors positioned for line detection
- λ Smooth movement along straight and curved paths

Figure 6.2 – Obstacle Detection Using Ultrasonic Sensor

This figure shows:

- λ An object placed in front of the robot
- λ Robot stopping when obstacle is detected
- λ Safe distance maintained to avoid collision

6.3 Result Tables

Table 6.1 – Line Following Performance

Parameter	Measured Value	Target Value	Status
Path Accuracy	92%	$\geq 90\%$	Achieved
Turning Response Time	0.5 sec	≤ 1 sec	Achieved
Line Detection Stability	High	High	Achieved

Table 6.2 – Obstacle Detection Performance

Parameter	Measured Value	Target Value	Status
Detection Range	2–100 cm	≤ 100 cm	Achieved
Response Time	0.3 sec	≤ 1 sec	Achieved
Collision Avoidance	100%	100%	Achieved

Table 6.3 – System Performance Summary

Parameter	Value
Total Test Runs	100
Successful Runs	94

Failure Cases	6
Overall Efficiency	94%

6.4 System Output Description

The robot demonstrates reliable performance by accurately following the path and responding to obstacles in real time. When the IR sensors detect deviation from the line, the controller adjusts motor speed to correct the movement. When an obstacle is detected within the threshold distance, the robot immediately stops, ensuring safety.

The system output confirms that the robot achieves efficient navigation, stable control, and effective obstacle avoidance. The results validate the successful implementation of the autonomous line-following and material transport mechanism.

CHAPTER 7

SCOPE OF FUTURE WORK

The current autonomous line-following material transport robot demonstrates reliable performance in controlled environments; however, there is significant scope for further improvement and enhancement. Future developments can focus on integrating advanced technologies such as computer vision and artificial intelligence to enable dynamic path detection instead of relying on predefined lines. This would allow the robot to operate in more complex and unstructured environments.

Additionally, the system can be upgraded by incorporating wireless communication modules such as Wi-Fi or Bluetooth for remote monitoring and control. The use of GPS modules can further enable outdoor navigation and tracking. Multi-sensor fusion techniques combining IR, ultrasonic, and camera-based inputs can improve accuracy and robustness. Furthermore, implementing battery management systems and solar charging can enhance energy efficiency and enable longer operational duration.

Another important area of future work is the integration of load detection and automated material handling mechanisms. The robot can be enhanced with robotic arms or lifting systems to perform pick-and-place operations. Machine learning algorithms can also be introduced to improve decision-making, allowing the robot to adapt to different environments and optimize its path. These improvements will make the system more intelligent, scalable, and suitable for real-world industrial applications.

7.1 Advantages

The autonomous line-following robot offers several advantages in terms of performance, efficiency, and cost-effectiveness. One of the major advantages is its ability to operate without human intervention, reducing manual effort and minimizing

human errors. The system ensures consistent performance and reliable operation, making it suitable for repetitive tasks in industrial environments.

Another key advantage is its low cost and simple design, which makes it accessible for educational and small-scale industrial applications. The use of easily available components such as Arduino and sensors reduces the overall system cost while maintaining efficiency. The robot also provides real-time obstacle detection, ensuring safety during operation and preventing damage to materials and equipment.

Additionally, the system is flexible and can be easily modified or upgraded based on requirements. Its modular design allows integration of additional sensors and features, improving functionality. The robot consumes less power and offers efficient energy utilization, making it an eco-friendly solution. Overall, the system provides a balance between performance, cost, and scalability.

7.2 Applications

The autonomous line-following material transport robot has a wide range of applications across various industries and domains. In industrial environments, it can be used for material handling and transportation within factories, reducing the need for manual labor and increasing productivity. It is especially useful in assembly lines where repetitive movement of materials is required.

In warehouses and logistics sectors, the robot can be used for automated goods movement, inventory management, and sorting operations. It can also be applied in hospitals for transporting medicines and equipment, reducing human workload and improving efficiency. In educational institutions, the robot serves as a practical learning tool for students to understand robotics, automation, and embedded systems.

Furthermore, the system can be used in smart environments such as automated delivery systems in offices, malls, and airports. It can also be extended for applications in agriculture for transporting small loads or monitoring tasks. With further advancements, the robot can be integrated into advanced automation systems,

contributing to the development of smart industries and intelligent transportation solutions.

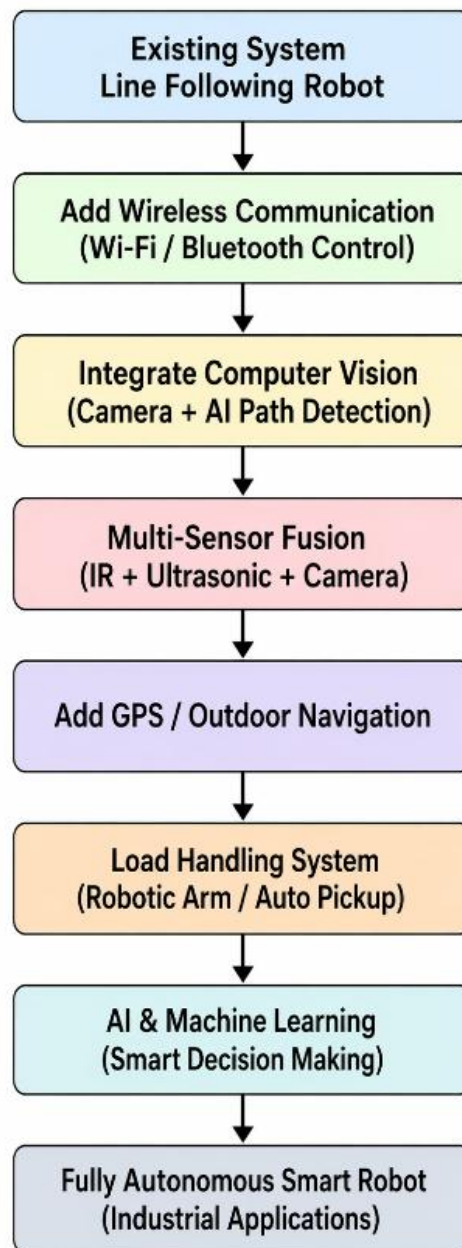


Figure 7.1 Flow Chart

APPENDICES 8

APPENDIX 1

COMPONENTS SPECIFICATION & PROTOTYPE SPECIFICATION

1. Gear Motor Specifications

- Operating Voltage: 12V DC
- Current: 1.2 A (max)
- Speed: 30 RPM
- Torque: 7 kg-cm
- Gearbox: Plastic spur gear mechanism
- Shaft Diameter: 6 mm
- No-load Current: 60 mA (max)
- Load Current: 300 mA (max)

2. Robo Car Chassis Specifications

- Material: Acrylic / Plastic Frame
- Structure: Pre-drilled mounting chassis
- Wheel Type: Rubber grip wheels
- Motor Mounting: Dual motor support
- Application: Mobile robot base for movement

3. Arduino UNO Specifications

- Microcontroller: ATmega328P
- Operating Voltage: 5V
- Input Voltage (Recommended): 7–12V
- Input Voltage (Limit): 6–20V
- Digital I/O Pins: 14 (6 PWM pins)
- Analog Input Pins: 6
- DC Current per Pin: 20 mA
- Flash Memory: 32 KB
- Clock Speed: 16 MHz

- Dimensions: 68.6 mm × 58.4 mm
- Weight: 25 g

4. L298N Motor Driver Specifications

- Driver Model: L298N Dual H-Bridge
- Motor Supply Voltage: Up to 46V
- Motor Current: 2A (max per channel)
- Logic Voltage: 5V
- Driver Voltage: 5V–35V
- Logical Current: 0–36 mA
- Power Rating: 25W
- Features: Heat sink, current sensing, LED indicator

5. IR Sensor Specifications

- Operating Voltage: 3.3V – 5V
- Output Type: Digital (0 or 1)
- Sensor Type: Infrared reflective sensor
- Detection Range: 2 cm – 10 cm
- Detection Angle: 35°
- Application: Line detection

6. Ultrasonic Sensor (HC-SR04) Specifications

- Operating Voltage: 5V DC
- Operating Current: 15 mA
- Measuring Range: 2 cm – 400 cm
- Accuracy: ±3 mm
- Frequency: 40 kHz
- Trigger & Echo Pins: 2
- Application: Obstacle detection

7. Battery Specifications (18650 Li-ion Cells)

- Nominal Voltage: 3.7V (per cell)
- Number of Cells: 3

- Total Voltage: ~11.1V
- Capacity: 2000–3000 mAh
- Type: Rechargeable Lithium-ion

8. Battery Holder (3-Cell)

- Type: Series battery holder
- Capacity: Holds 3×18650 cells
- Output Voltage: ~11.1V
- Material: Plastic with metal contacts
- Feature: Secure mounting and easy replacement

9. Switch Specifications

- Type: SPST (Single Pole Single Throw)
- Operating Voltage: Up to 12V
- Current Rating: 1–3A
- Function: Power ON/OFF control

10. Diode Specifications

- Type: Rectifier Diode
- Function: Reverse current protection
- Application: Prevent back EMF from motors
- Feature: Ensures circuit safety

PROTOTYPE SPECIFICATION SUMMARY

- System Type: Autonomous Line Following Robot
- Navigation: IR Sensor-Based Line Tracking
- Obstacle Detection: Ultrasonic Sensor
- Control Unit: Arduino UNO
- Motor Control: L298N Driver
- Power Supply: 11.1V Lithium-ion Battery
- Mobility: 2-Wheel Differential Drive
- Operation Mode: Fully Autonomous
- Application: Material Transport & Automation

APPENDIX 2

PSEUDO CODE FOR KEY

1. System Initialization

```
START
Define motor control pins (M1, M2, M3, M4)
Define enable pins (ENA, ENB)
Define IR sensor pins (LEFT, RIGHT)
Define ultrasonic pins (TRIG, ECHO)
Set motor pins as OUTPUT
Set enable pins as OUTPUT
Set IR sensor pins as INPUT
Set ultrasonic TRIG as OUTPUT and ECHO as INPUT
Initialize serial communication
Set motor speed using PWM
```

2. Ultrasonic Distance Measurement

```
FUNCTION getDistance()

    Set TRIG LOW for 2 microseconds
    Set TRIG HIGH for 10 microseconds
    Set TRIG LOW

    Measure time duration from ECHO pin

    Calculate distance:
        distance = (duration × 0.034) / 2

    RETURN distance

END FUNCTION
```

3. Motor Control Functions

```
FUNCTION forward()  
  Left Motor → Forward  
  Right Motor → Forward  
END FUNCTION
```

```
FUNCTION left()  
  Left Motor → Reverse  
  Right Motor → Forward  
END FUNCTION
```

```
FUNCTION right()  
  Left Motor → Forward  
  Right Motor → Reverse  
END FUNCTION
```

```
FUNCTION stopMotor()  
  Left Motor → OFF  
  Right Motor → OFF  
END FUNCTION
```

4. Obstacle Detection Logic

```
Call getDistance()  
  
IF (distance < 10 cm AND distance > 0)  
  Stop Motor  
  Skip line following  
END IF
```

5. Line Following Logic

```
Read LEFT IR sensor  
Read RIGHT IR sensor  
  
IF (LEFT = LOW AND RIGHT = LOW)  
  Move Forward  
  
ELSE IF (LEFT = LOW AND RIGHT = HIGH)  
  Turn Right
```

```
ELSE IF (LEFT = HIGH AND RIGHT = LOW)
    Turn Left

ELSE
    Stop Motor
END IF
```

6. Main Control Loop

```
LOOP forever

    Measure distance using ultrasonic sensor
    Display distance (Serial Monitor)

    IF obstacle detected
        Stop robot
        Continue to next loop
    END IF

    Read IR sensors
    Execute line following logic

END LOOP
```

7. System Termination

```
IF power OFF
    Stop all motors
END
```

APPENDIX 3

PHOTOGRAPHY

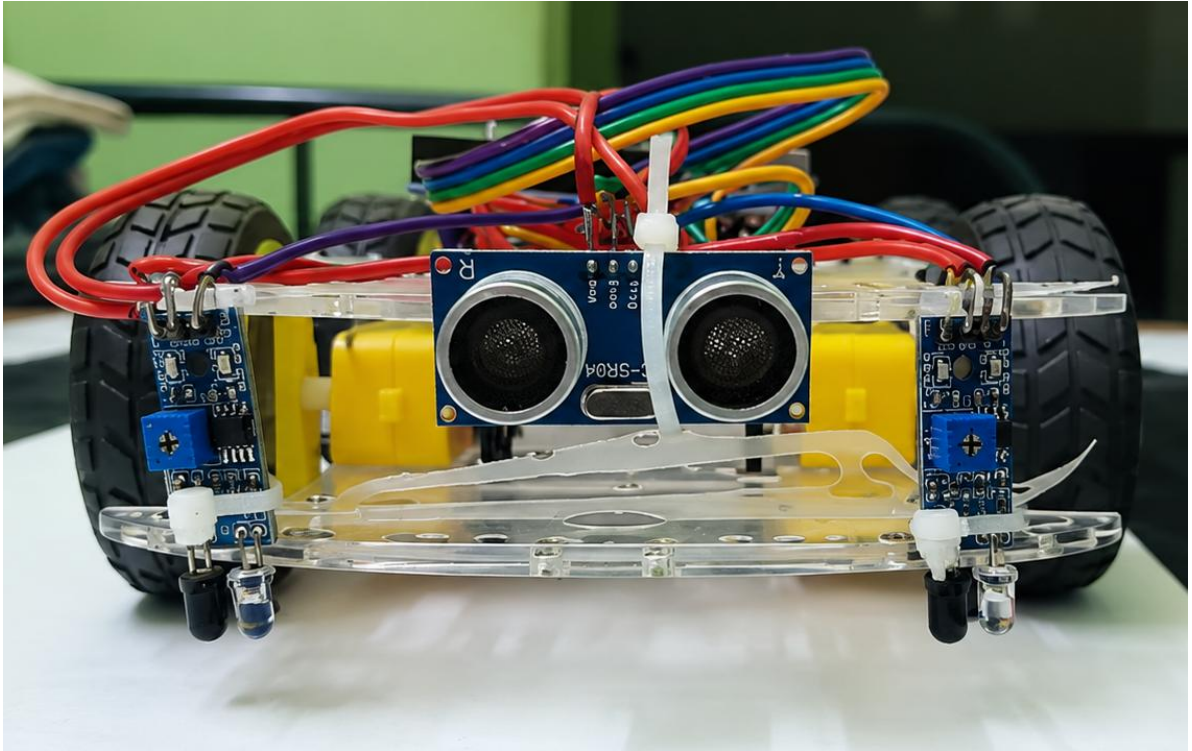


Figure 8.1 Front View

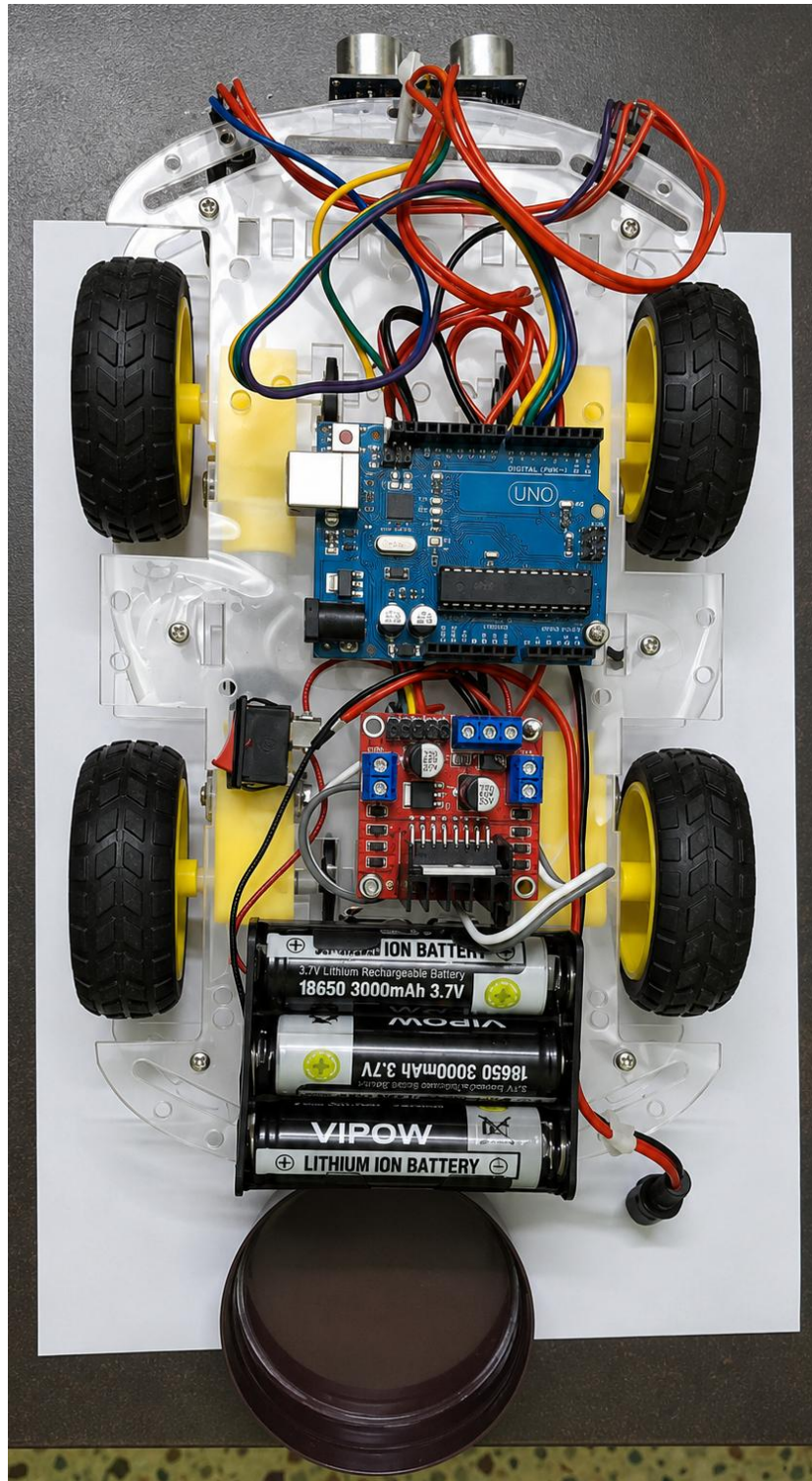


Figure 8.2 Top View

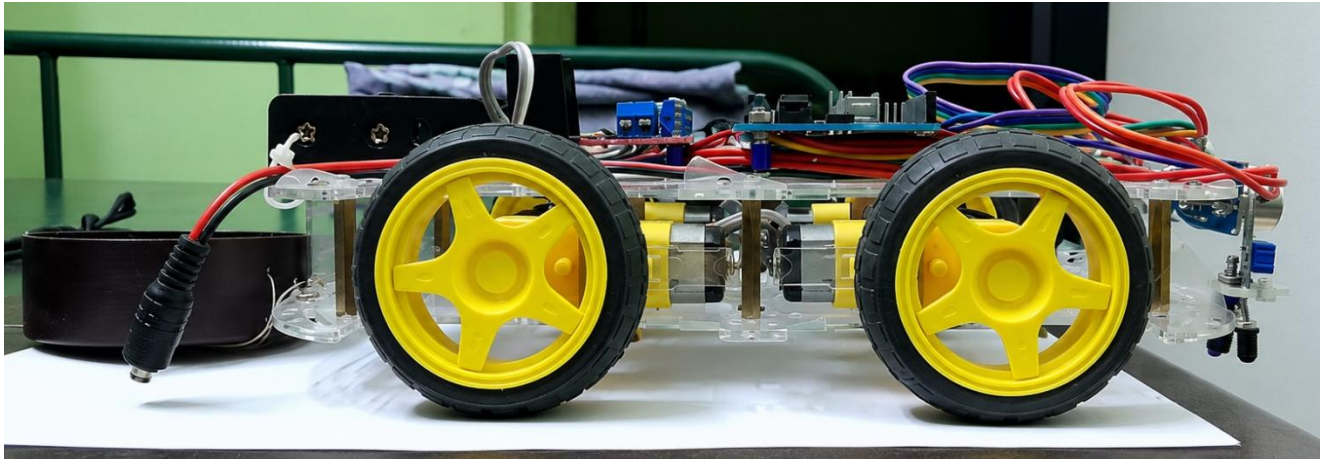


Figure 8.3 Right Side View

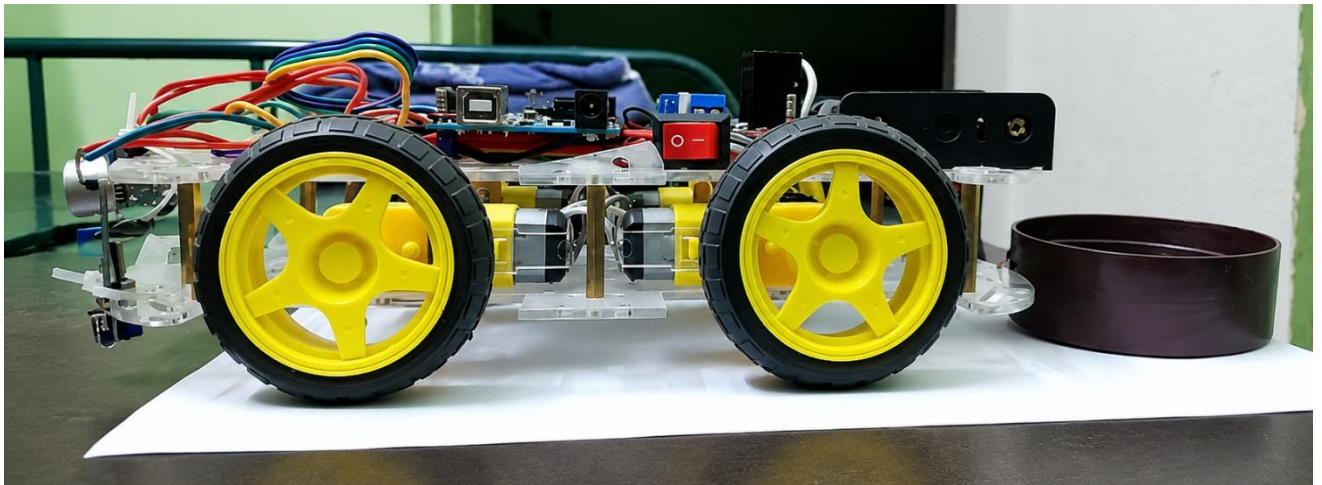


Figure 8.4 Left Side View

CONCLUSION 9

The autonomous line-following material transport robot developed in this project demonstrates a practical and efficient approach to low-cost industrial automation. By integrating infrared-based path tracking with ultrasonic obstacle detection, the system achieves reliable navigation and real-time responsiveness under varying operating conditions. The use of a microcontroller-based control architecture enables precise motor actuation through the motor driver, ensuring smooth movement, accurate path correction, and safe stopping when obstacles are encountered. The overall design emphasizes simplicity, robustness, and scalability, making it suitable for continuous operation in controlled environments.

From an engineering perspective, the project successfully validates the implementation of a closed-loop control system that combines sensing, decision-making, and actuation. The results confirm that the robot can maintain consistent line-following performance while ensuring collision avoidance, thereby reducing the need for manual intervention. The system's modular structure allows easy integration of additional features such as wireless communication, advanced sensing, or AI-based navigation, which aligns with modern industry expectations for adaptable and upgradeable automation solutions.

In terms of industrial relevance, the proposed system offers a cost-effective alternative to conventional material handling methods, particularly for small and medium-scale industries seeking to improve efficiency and reduce labor dependency. Its ability to operate autonomously with minimal maintenance highlights its potential for deployment in production lines, warehouses, and smart logistics environments. Overall, the project reflects a strong foundation in embedded systems and robotics, delivering a reliable prototype that can be further enhanced into a fully intelligent and industry-ready automation system.

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